

Unit 3 assessment

Unit summary

Teacher effectiveness means the effect a teacher has on pupils' learning, but the definitions in use disagree about which effects count. Achievement gain counts what the test tests; observed practice can be satisfied by a performance; breadth of learner outcomes counts more of what matters and measures it less reliably. Institutions often state one definition and appraise against another. More workable than a single definition is a set of components, within the classroom and beyond it, held as evidence rather than summed into a score.

The qualities a teacher brings work on those components rather than producing learning directly. Attitude toward the profession is a stance rather than a feeling. Professional image is layered, with appearance the thin outer band and competence the core. Each of the seven named traits has a failure mode at excess which is the trait unbalanced rather than its opposite, so more is not better and "you either have it or you do not" does not hold. Humour is the one exception: aimed at a pupil it is the trait inverted rather than overdone, and it is corrected by changing target.

Every stakeholder relationship exists for a purpose the work depends on, and is built by reliability rather than by being liked. Conflict is normal; the professional difference lies in moving the conversation, letting the person finish, admitting missing facts with a commitment, and escalating what is not yours while recording why.

Communication runs on two channels. Verbal communication explains, instructs, questions and responds, and questioning is where teachers most differ. Non-verbal communication runs on proximity, orientation, gaze, expression, gesture and vocal variety, and learners read it as evidence about teaching quality, on evidence drawn from university students rather than schoolchildren. That the non-verbal channel prevails when the two contradict is a practitioner's heuristic worth acting on rather than a finding this unit's sources establish.

Five roles have been added to transmitting content: facilitator, researcher, change agent, moral agent and life-long learner. They are cumulative, not

sequential, and the researcher role is what turns a tried change into a learned one.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. A teacher raises examination marks by narrowing teaching to past papers. On which definition of effectiveness does this look best, and which does it damage? (*Understand*) a) Best on observed practice; damages achievement gain b) Best on breadth of outcomes; damages observed practice c) Best on achievement gain; damages breadth of learner outcomes d) It looks equally good on all three
2. Which of the following is a factor **beyond** classroom processes? (*Remember*) a) Contribution to colleagues b) Explanation and questioning c) Use of assessment d) Classroom climate
3. A teacher's attitude toward the profession is best evidenced by: (*Understand*) a) stated enthusiasm for the subject b) ordinary conduct such as preparedness, punctuality and follow-through c) length of service d) qualifications held
4. Empathy at excess most characteristically produces a teacher who: (*Apply*) a) is cold toward pupils in difficulty b) avoids contact with parents c) enforces rules inconsistently d) excuses everything and lowers what is expected
5. The relationship between a teacher and a pupil's parents primarily exists so that: (*Understand*) a) the parent will act at home and the teacher learns what they cannot see b) the teacher is liked in the community c) complaints are reduced d) attendance figures improve
6. In the de-escalation sequence, the reason for moving an angry conversation out of a corridor is chiefly that: (*Understand*) a) it is quieter b) school rules require it c) it protects the other person's dignity, and someone who has lost face cannot climb down d) it delays the conversation

7. "Does everyone understand?" is a weak comprehension check mainly because it: (*Apply*) a) takes too long b) cannot be asked of a large class c) is too informal d) samples confidence rather than comprehension, and over-samples pupils already secure
8. The claim that learners follow the non-verbal channel when the two contradict is best described as: (*Understand*) a) an established finding of the studies cited in this unit b) a practitioner's heuristic that descends from the same experiments as the 93% claim c) a claim disproved by Furlich's study d) a rule that applies only to university students
9. A teacher changes one thing about a topic, decides in advance what evidence would show whether it worked, and keeps last year's results to compare. This is chiefly the role of: (*Apply*) a) researcher b) facilitator c) change agent d) moral agent
10. The five evolving roles are best understood as: (*Understand*) a) replacements for transmitting content b) stages a teacher passes through in order c) alternatives from which a teacher chooses one d) additions on top of transmitting content

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. State three competing definitions of teacher effectiveness and, for each, name one thing it captures and one it misses. (*Understand*)
2. Explain why summing the components of effectiveness into a single score is a worse instrument than holding them separately. (*Analyze*)
3. Explain the layered model of professional image, and say why investing an evening in appearance before a first lesson is a misallocation. (*Understand*)
4. Choose three of the seven personality traits. For each, state the working form and the failure mode at excess, and name what would balance it. (*Analyze*)
5. State what each of the five stakeholder relationships is for, in terms of what part of the work depends on it. (*Remember*)

6. A teacher answers a parent's complaint immediately and confidently and is later shown to have been wrong on a fact. Explain what this costs beyond the immediate error. *(Analyze)*
7. Name the four jobs of verbal communication, and explain why the sentence immediately after a pupil answers is the most consequential one. *(Understand)*
8. List five non-verbal channels and give the classroom use of each. *(Remember)*
9. Explain the difference between a teacher who tries new methods and a teacher exercising the researcher role. *(Understand)*
10. Explain why a newly qualified teacher who criticises established practice is not thereby a change agent, and state what would have to come first. *(Analyze)*

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. **Integrative.** Mr Junaid and Miss Shazia produced identical board results by opposite methods. Judge them both against the components of teacher effectiveness, drawing evidence from the qualities, relationships, communication and roles covered across this unit. Reach a defended verdict and state what further evidence would change it. *(Evaluate)*
2. Take one of the seven personality traits and write a case study of a teacher whose strength in it became a liability. Identify what was missing that would have balanced it, and the point at which the teacher could reasonably have noticed. *(Analyze)*
3. A parent arrives angry, in a corridor, in front of other parents, convinced their child has been penalised because the family cannot pay for tuition. Set out how you would handle the first five minutes and defend each move, then address the objection that de-escalation reads as the school closing ranks. *(Evaluate)*
4. Design a short sequence of instruction for a topic of your choice in which the verbal and non-verbal channels are deliberately coordinated. Specify

both channels concretely, and explain what each element is doing and how you would know whether it worked. *(Create)*

5. "The five evolving roles are unrealistic for a teacher in a Pakistani government school with sixty pupils in a class and no resources." Evaluate this claim. Your answer must take the objection seriously, distinguish which roles it genuinely constrains from which it does not, and reach a position. *(Evaluate)*

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **c** - narrowing to the test raises measured attainment while reducing the breadth of what was learned.
2. **a** - contribution to colleagues sits outside classroom processes; the other three are within.
3. **b** - attitude is read from ordinary conduct, which is why it cannot be asserted.
4. **d** - the excess of empathy is excusing, which communicates lowered expectation.
5. **a** - the relationship is instrumental in both directions: action at home, and information the classroom cannot supply.
6. **c** - dignity, and the practical impossibility of retreating in front of an audience.
7. **d** - it samples confidence, and the pupils who answer are the ones who least need checking.
8. **b** - worth acting on, and not established by the sources cited here; discarding the number while keeping its conclusion would be the same citation failure. (c) overstates: Furlich's null result concerned immediacy and motivation, not channel contradiction.
9. **a** - the advance decision about evidence and the comparison are what make it research.
10. **d** - cumulative; a teacher who cannot explain has skipped transmission, not surpassed it.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

- 1. (6 marks)** One mark per definition correctly stated (3); one mark per apt captures/misses pair (3). Achievement gain: captures learning, misses what the test omits. Observed practice: captures process, can be satisfied by performance. Breadth: captures more of what matters, measures unreliably.
- 2. (4 marks)** A total conceals the judgements in the weighting (1); components serve different purposes and an instrument built for development is not fit for appraisal (1); components interact, so a sum implies an independence that does not hold (1); a number invites comparison it cannot support (1).
- 3. (4 marks)** Names the layers in order, appearance, conduct, reliability, competence (2); explains that appearance buys brief attention and is quickly spent (1); identifies that the inner layers carry a career and cannot be assembled overnight, which is why the evening was misallocated (1).
- 4. (9 marks)** Three marks per trait: working form (1), failure mode (1), the balancing trait or component (1). The failure mode must normally be the trait unbalanced rather than its opposite. **Humour is the exception:** a candidate who gives "aimed at a pupil" as humour's failure is correct and should receive full credit, provided they identify it as inversion rather than excess. Do not mark it down for not being an excess.
- 5. (5 marks)** One mark each: pupils, so confusion is admitted; parents, so action happens at home and the teacher learns what they cannot see; colleagues, so practice improves and handling is consistent; the institution, so things can be authorised and concerns heard; the community, so the school can ask things of it.
- 6. (4 marks)** The factual error itself (1); the loss of the parent's trust in anything the teacher says subsequently (1); the precedent that the teacher answers before checking (1); the cost to the pupil, whose issue is now entangled with an adult dispute (1).
- 7. (5 marks)** Explaining, instructing, questioning, responding (2); the response teaches the whole class what happens to people who answer (2); a wrong answer met with curiosity surfaces a misconception the class shares (1).

8. (5 marks) One mark per channel with an apt classroom use, from proximity, body orientation, gaze and eye contact, facial expression, gesture, vocal variety.

9. (4 marks) Trying is adopting or abandoning on how the lesson felt (1); the researcher forms a question and changes one thing (1); decides in advance what evidence would show whether it worked (1); is willing to conclude it did not (1).

10. (4 marks) Change requires standing (1); standing is earned by visible competence in the ordinary work (1); arriving critical ensures the criticism is not heard (1); states what comes first, namely doing the core job well and building credit (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 across four criteria. A response that does not reach "Adequate" on the analysis or evaluation criterion cannot exceed 10 overall, whatever its other merits.

ERQ 1 - Integrative judgement of two teachers

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of components	Fewer than three, or applied to one teacher only	Four or more, applied to both	Components chosen for relevance, including inconvenient ones
Breadth across the unit	Draws on Topic 3.1 only	Draws on two or more topics	Uses qualities, relationships, communication and roles as evidence
Defended verdict (Evaluate)	No verdict, or "both have strengths"	A verdict with a reason	States the criterion the verdict rests on and defends choosing it

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Evidence discipline	Inference presented as fact	Distinguishes stated from inferred	Names the further evidence that would change the verdict

ERQ 2 - A trait at excess

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Grasp of the trait	Describes only the excess	Describes working form and excess	Shows the same disposition producing both
Continuity	Two different teachers contrasted	One teacher throughout	The transition is traced, not asserted
Analysis of imbalance (Analyze)	Names no balancing factor	Names one	Explains the mechanism by which the absence produced the harm
Detection point	Hindsight only	A plausible moment	A realistic signal available at the time

ERQ 3 - The angry parent

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the sequence	Moves unordered	Ordered and tied to decision points	Each move justified by what it protects

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Realism	Idealised meeting	Accounts for corridor and audience	Accounts for the accusation's specific content
Answering the objection (Evaluate)	Ignores or dismisses it	Answers it	Shows concretely what prevents the closing-ranks reading
Protection of the pupil	Pupil absent from the answer	Pupil considered	Ends with something actionable for the pupil

ERQ 4 - Coordinated channels

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Verbal specification	Generic advice	Specific words given	Words suited to the named topic and class
Non-verbal specification	Named only	Position, gaze, pace specified	Specified concretely enough to be enacted by someone else
Design reasoning (Create)	Elements listed	Each element justified	Coordination between channels is the design, not two lists
Evaluation plan	None	States what would be observed	States what result would count as failure

ERQ 5 - Are the roles realistic?

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Engagement with the objection	Dismisses it	Concedes real constraints	Takes the strongest form of the objection
Discrimination between roles	Treats all five alike	Separates constrained from unconstrained	Argues per role with the specific constraint named
Position reached (Evaluate)	No position	A position	A defended position that survives the objection rather than avoiding it
Contextual grounding	Generic	Refers to Pakistani conditions	Uses specific conditions, such as class size or resources, in the argument

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